

Website Script for Emerging Talent (1):

01

ADDRESSING UNCERTAINTIES



02

RESOURCES



03

TOOLKIT



04

CONNECTION + NETWORKING



1. ADDRESSING UNCERTAINTIES:

It is okay not to know everything. Starting a new role can feel very overwhelming; employees may be unsure about workplace expectations, communication styles, responsibilities, or when to ask for help. Asking questions and seeking clarification are important parts of learning and professional growth.

Concern

What You Can Do

“I am afraid to ask questions.”

Write down your questions and ask your manager, mentor, buddy, or teammate at an appropriate time. Asking thoughtful questions shows that you want to understand and perform well.

“I am worried about making a mistake.”

Mistakes can happen while learning. Communicate the mistake early, take responsibility, ask how to correct it, and apply what you learned in the future.

“I do not understand what is expected of me.”

Ask your manager to clarify priorities, deadlines, responsibilities, and what successful work should look like.

“I am unsure how to communicate professionally.”

Review the Employee Handbook and available Outlook, Teams, professional attire, and workplace etiquette resources. Observe team norms and ask your manager when expectations are unclear.

“I feel like I do not belong or that am behind others.”

Remember that employees enter the workplace with different experiences. Connect with peers, employee networks, mentors, and available support resources rather than comparing your starting point with someone else’s.

2. RESOURCES:

1. For Professional Attire refer to:

A) Employee Handbook Dress Code Page 31.

<https://evarooms.merckgroup.com/Location/EMD-Canada/HR%20Docs/Employee%20Handbook.pdf#search=professional%20attire>

A secondary attire source and more inclusive professional dress examples from Harvard:

B) Harvard University Mignone Center for Career Success. (n.d.). *Professional attire guide*.

<https://careerservices.fas.harvard.edu/resources/mcs-professional-attire-guide/>

2. For professional electronic communication refer to:

A) Employee Handbook Office Etiquette/Professional Courtesy, page 19

Also review Employee Handbook: Employee Standards and Conduct, page 8

<https://evarooms.merckgroup.com/Location/EMD-Canada/HR%20Docs/Employee%20Handbook.pdf#search=EMPLOYEE%20HANDBOOK>

For guidance on writing clear, concise, and professional emails, including effective subject lines, appropriate tone, message organization, and proper use of features such as Reply All, Bcc, attachments, and distribution lists. Refer to Microsoft's article on the topic.

B) Microsoft. (n.d.). *Outlook best practices: Write great email*.

3.Toolkit: Best for: Email formatting, subject lines, To and Cc, Bcc, Reply All, follow-ups, signatures, and action requests.

Microsoft recommends descriptive and action oriented subject lines, concise messages, placing important information first, separating action items, and using the **To** line for people expected to act and **Cc** for people who only need to be informed.

Use this source for:

- Email structure
- To versus Cc
- When to use Bcc
- Subject-line examples
- Follow-up etiquette
- Email signatures
- When to use email versus a call or instant message

The toolkit reference includes guidance on how to:

- Request feedback
- Ask for clarification
- Send a meeting request
- Follow up after receiving no response
- Communicate a delay
- Thank someone for their time
- Introduce themselves professionally
-

Toolkit Professional attire:

Attire standards differ by company, country, industry, location, laboratory requirements, and job responsibilities. The toolkit encourages employees to review company policy, observe colleagues in similar roles, and ask questions when expectations are unclear.

The toolkit reference explains the difference between:

- Business formal

- Business professional
- Business casual
- Smart casual
- Casual attire
- Safety specific attire

4. Connection and Networking

Use this source for:

- Networking
- Informational interviews
- Preparing questions
- Requesting a career conversation
- Following up afterward
- Building professional relationships

The toolkit could reduce barriers by providing:

- A definition of informational interviewing
- A networking request template
- Suggested questions
- A meeting preparation checklist
- A thank you email template
- Examples of appropriate and inappropriate requests
- A reflection worksheet for documenting what was learned
- Guidance on finding mentors, sponsors, alumni, and internal contacts